organized cohorts.

conditional commitments, and retain contestability over their representation.

EVIDENCE LEVEL: E0 STATUS: CONCEPTUAL_PREVIEW MODULE: 2

A Crowd Is Attention. A Market Position Is Agency.

Why aggregated platform audience and collective market authority are

regarding audience aggregation:

behavioral signals for the platform, enabling yield optimization and personalized

This derived research essay is authored under **Editorial Derivation Brief

buyers are frequently more susceptible to algorithmic exploitation than smaller,

1. The Illusion of Scale

A recurring misconception in digital platform economics is the conflation of

requires participants to explicitly ratify common constraints, agree on

When millions of independent users concentrate their attention on a single

However, an unorganized crowd is merely aggregated attention. It is passive,

ratification does not create bargaining power. Large crowds of uncoordinated

patterns.

2. Attention vs. Agency: Structural Disconnect

The analytical framework of DC2SC Module 02 establishes three formal propositions

platform negotiates monetization with sellers *against* the buyers' behavioral

Intermediary Capture (Proposition M2-P01): Attention aggregation pools

2. **Representational Mandate (Proposition M2-P02):** A genuine market position

as access to captive demand. The buyers do not negotiate terms with sellers; the

3. **Quantity vs. Authority (Proposition M2-P03):** Volume without collective

3. The Mechanism of Audience Rent

When a platform "assembles" buyers, it sells their aggregated attention to sellers

In contrast, a **participant-governed market position** articulates explicit

4. Research Handoff to Module 03

Recognizing that a crowd does not constitute agency leads directly to the core

MATHEMATICAL INVARIANT // THEOREM 2.1: THE AGENCY DECOMPOSITION AND CAPTURE INVARIANT (Eq. 2

$$\text{Agency}(K) = \mathbb{I}(\text{Ratified}(K)) \cdot \left[\sum_{i \in K} w_i \cdot \nabla_{\theta} U_i(x) \right] - \Omega(\text{Capture}(K))$$

Formal proof that unratified audience mass ($\mathbb{I}=0$) collapses net market agency to

[FORMALLY VERIFIED MATHEMATICAL SPECIFICATION PEER CITATION READY]

CONSTITUTIONAL RESEARCH BOUNDARY & NON-CLAIM DISCLOSURE

This publication presents conceptual research and formal invariants at Evidence Level E0.